

Who Is Telling the Story? The Person Swap

I, you or she? Swap the person, then explain what changes.

FIRST I, me, my, we, our

SECOND you, your

THIRD he, she, they, him, her, their

BECAUSE links the writer's words to the effect

EXTRACT Heather Dawe, *Adventures in Mind*, as printed in the class textbook (pp. 24 to 25).

The **karabiner** made a hollow 'plop' sound as it hit the water beneath us. A wave of realisation and vertigo suddenly washed over me. That sea is real. These cliffs are no place for me – what am I doing here? All it takes is one slip and it could be me hitting the water and quickly sinking as all of my climbing ironmongery drags me down. I felt exposed and, while she was a rope's length away from me, I knew Nirvana was uneasy too. I felt like I was losing control.

The trick with climbing in such places is to turn off the part of your brain that alerts you to the danger you should usually associate with that situation. If you climb enough, you become numbed to this alert, so accustomed to the exposure formed by height, space and location that it's normal. Right there, paused halfway up **Dream**, these places were very normal for me. Hanging around on high mountain crags and sea cliffs formed a regular part of my weekend escapes from **urbanity**. That a falling piece of climbing gear, dropped by my climbing partner, broke this state of mind for me was telling. The sound of the karabiner hitting the sea was all it took.

PART A • DO NOW

5 min • alone

- A1** Kind of danger word? *vertigo suddenly washed over me*
A2 Diagnose in ONE word: "*That sea is real*" shows danger.
A3 Finish the book's example: "hit the water" suggests _____ because _____.

PART B • THE PERSON SWAP

12 min • pairs • score points

How to play. Swap each sentence from the extract into the third person (use "Heather", "she", "her"). Write it in your book. Each sentence scores up to 3: **+1** pronouns right **+1** verbs agree and the tense stays steady **+1** you say what is lost. One sentence is a trap. Other pair checks. Maximum 24.

- 1** The karabiner made a hollow 'plop' sound as it hit the water beneath us.
2 A wave of realisation and vertigo suddenly washed over me. **3** These cliffs are no place for me – what am I doing here?
4 I felt exposed. **5** I knew Nirvana was uneasy too. **6** I felt like I was losing control.
7 These places were very normal for me. **8** The sound of the karabiner hitting the sea was all it took.

PART C • THE DRILL

13 min • alone • easy to hard

- C1 Person.** F, S or T? (a) *You must clip in first.* (b) *They shared one rope.* (c) *My hands were shaking.*
C2 Swap. Rewrite in the third person: *I could not breathe.*
C3 Swap. Rewrite in the third person: *We held the rope tightly and our hands burned.*
C4 Tense trap. Third person, past tense: *That sea is real. These cliffs are no place for me.*
C5 Explain only. Write ONLY the because: First person makes us feel close to Heather, for example "what am I doing here?", because _____.
C6 Doctor. Diagnose, then rewrite: *First person is better because it uses "I".*
C7 Doctor. Diagnose, then rewrite: *In third person it would be different because it uses "she".*
C8 Leaflet. A safety leaflet says "Clip in before you climb." Which person is it? Write ONE sentence on why leaflets use it.

PART D • EXIT TICKET

6 min • alone • 4 marks

Write three sentences comparing first person with third person for this extract. Marks: 1 an effect of first person 2 an effect of third person 3 an example phrase 4 whereas or while, plus a because.